



10



COVER STORY: INDIA MEN AND WOMEN'S HOCKEY TEAMS FACE THEIR BIGGEST TEST OF THE YEAR

Cricket

- 26 **Duleep Trophy preview**
A knock-out format that could shape India's Test future
- 38 **Big Interview**
Tamil Nadu captain, Sai Kishore, discusses leadership, workload, evolving skills, and his team's Ranji Trophy ambitions
- 51 **Appreciation**
Cheteshwar Pujara, the last of India's Test purists, announces retirement



78 Athletics Perspective

Indian sprint on the surge despite administrative flip-flops

Cover: Harmanpreet Singh & Salima Tete (K. Murali Kumar)

Read more...

- 56 **Pro Kabaddi League**
The 12th edition is here and the league is borrowing ideas from its cricketing cousin — Indian Premier League
- 68 **Football Interview**
Khalid Jamil, India's first homegrown coach in 13 years, is ready to accept the challenge
- 72 **Tennis**
U.S. Open mixed doubles' new format — a bold gamble and a mixed verdict

Editorial Team

Editor: Ayon Sengupta
Convergence Editor: V. V. Rajasekhara Rao
Design: R. Ravikannan
Editorial Consultant: Vijay Lokapally
Sr. Assistant Editor: Shayan Acharya
Assistant Editor: Jonathan Selvaraj
Chief Sub-Editor: Karan Pillai, Ayan Acharya, Aashin Prasad, Santadeep Dey, Lavanya Lakshmi Narayanan
Sr. Sub-Editor/Sr. Reporter: Saikat Chakraborty, Dhruva Prasad, Neeladri Bhattacharjee, Aneesh Dey, Pranay Rajiv, Nihit Sachdeva, Abhishek Saini
Sub-Editor/Reporter: Nigamanth P, Anish P, Sahil Mathur, Joan Mathew Jacob, Rajdeep Saha, Kavita Menon, Aditya Padinjat
Senior Multimedia Producer: Sivasankar A

For Subscription:
 Email: customercare@thehindu.co.in
 No: 18001021878

For Advertisement
 National Sales Head
 Satish K Mendon
Satish.mendon@thehindu.co.in
Region

Delhi – Antesh Kumar Verma
 +91 9818798519
Bengaluru – Gurunatha Reddy
 +91 9845529981
Chennai – R. Ganesh
 +91 9841290799

Poster: Dewald Brevis (AP); Pages 43-50

www.sportstar.thehindu.com
 mail to: sportstar@thehindu.co.in

Published by Nirmala Lakshman, Kasturi Buildings, 859, 860, Anna Salai, Chennai-600 002 and Printed by SDT Rao at Kala Jyothi Process Private Ltd, Plot no CFC-1&2, Survey No 18, E-City, SEZ & General Industrial Park, Raviryal & Srinagar (Village), Maheswaram(M), R.R.Dist, Telangana - 501359 on behalf of THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., Chennai-600 002.

Editor: Ayon Sengupta (Editor responsible for selection of news under the PRP Act).
 All rights reserved. Reproduction in whole or in part without written permission is prohibited.

Disclaimer: Readers are requested to verify & make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this magazine.

THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this magazine, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this magazine/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this magazine.

Air Surcharge:

Colombo ₹ 15.00 | Port Blair ₹ 10.00